

Sooraj Raju Match Prep Report

Opponent: Sooraj M R / Sooraj Menothuparambil Raju | rating 2147 | FIDE 35014730 | Leicestershire | no credible Chess.com account found

Bottom line: Sooraj Raju looks like a dynamic, calculation-ready and comfortable in open or semi-open structures player. This report is based on 315 source PGNs, 274 deduped games, with known dates spanning 2017.01.18 to 2026.05.04. Most recent parsed game: 2026.05.04 Rughani, Mahin - Sooraj M R 0-1.

Evidence	Value
Source PGNs	315
Deduped games used	274
Overall score in sample	172.5/270 (63.9%)
White score	99.5/143 (69.6%)
Black score	73/127 (57.5%)
Last 10 dated games	4.5/10 (45.0%)
Since 2025	67.5/109 (61.9%)
Confidence	High for opening/recency counts; medium for style, strengths and weaknesses without a fresh engine pass.

1. Style, Strengths And Weaknesses

Style read: dynamic, calculation-ready and comfortable in open or semi-open structures. The most important practical clue is not a single opening name, but the repeatability of his early structures shown below.

Main strengths	Main weaknesses
large public sample with repeated tournament structures, so his main habits are visible; clear White comfort zone around Open/anti Sicilian with 1.e4, French as White; clear Black comfort zone around Alekhine Defence, Dutch Defence; recent activity in the sample, so old repertoire notes should not be used alone	predictable first-move families as White if you prepare the exact move order; repeated Black structures that let you choose a targeted anti-system rather than broad prep; some repertoire clustering: he can be made to solve a prepared branch rather than choose freely

2. His White Repertoire

Family	Games	Score	Most common exact setup
Open/anti Sicilian with 1.e4	27	15.5/27 (57.4%)	1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. g3 g6 4. Bg2 Bg7 5. d3 d6
French as White	18	10/18 (55.6%)	1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nd2 c5 4. Ngf3 cxd4 5. exd5 Qxd5
Caro-Kann as White	15	14/15 (93.3%)	1. e4 c6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 e5 4. Ngf3 Bd6 5. d4 exd4
Scotch/Open Game central d4	11	10/11 (90.9%)	1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 exd4 4. Bc4 Nf6 5. e5 d5
Grand Prix / Closed Sicilian	10	9/10 (90.0%)	1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. g3 g6 4. Bg2 Bg7 5. f4 d6
Italian / Scotch Gambit as White	10	9.5/10 (95.0%)	1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. d4 exd4 5. O-O d6
Reti/KIA fianchetto	9	4/9 (44.4%)	1. Nf3 Nf6 2. g3 d5 3. Bg2 e6 4. O-O Be7 5. c4 O-O
1.e4 e5 Open Game as White	8	3/8 (37.5%)	1. e4 e5 2. Nc3 Nf6 3. Bc4 Nc6 4. d3 Na5 5. Nge2 Be7

Most repeated White setup fragments

- 1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. g3 g6 4. Bg2 Bg7 5. d3 d6 (15 games)
- 1. e4 c6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 e5 4. Ngf3 Bd6 5. d4 exd4 (8 games)
- 1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 d6 3. g3 Nc6 4. Bg2 g6 5. d3 Bg7 (5 games)
- 1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. d4 exd4 5. O-O d6 (4 games)
- 1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 exd4 4. Bc4 Nf6 5. e5 d5 (3 games)

3. His Black Repertoire

Family	Games	Score	Most common exact setup
Alekhine Defence	74	51/73 (69.9%)	1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. c4 Nb6 4. d4 d6 5. f4 dxe5
Dutch Defence	21	7.5/21 (35.7%)	1. d4 f5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. O-O O-O
KID / ...d6 fianchetto	7	3/7 (42.9%)	1. d4 Nf6 2. Nf3 g6 3. Bf4 Bg7 4. e3 d6 5. h3 O-O
KID/fianchetto vs flank	7	2.5/7 (35.7%)	1. c4 f5 2. Nc3 Nf6 3. d4 g6 4. g3 Bg7 5. Bg2 O-O
...Nf6/...g6 fianchetto vs flank	5	2.5/5 (50.0%)	1. Nf3 f5 2. c4 Nf6 3. e3 g6 4. d4 Bg7 5. b4 O-O
Black vs 1.d4 b6	4	0/4 (0.0%)	1. d4 b6 2. e4 Bb7 3. Nc3 e6 4. Bd3 Bb4 5. Nh3 Nf6
Black vs 1.d4 d6	4	1/4 (25.0%)	1. d4 d6 2. e4 Nf6 3. Nc3 Nbd7 4. f4 e5 5. Nf3 exd4
Unknown / fragment	4	1/1 (100.0%)	n/a

Most repeated Black setup fragments

- 1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. c4 Nb6 4. d4 d6 5. f4 dxe5 (12 games)
- 1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. c4 Nb6 5. f4 dxe5 (11 games)
- 1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. Nf3 g6 5. Bc4 Nb6 (8 games)
- 1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. c4 Nb6 5. exd6 cxd6 (6 games)
- 1. d4 f5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. O-O O-O (4 games)

Fianchetto shell note: in 69 d4/flank games where he used ...Nf6/...g6/...Bg7, the split is ...d6/KID-ish: 66, no early d-pawn: 3. Use the early d-pawn choice as the cue: ...d6 means KID/Benoni thinking, ...d5 means Catalan/Gruenfeld-style central pressure.

4. Recent Form And Recent Openings

Recent form snapshot: last 10 dated games score 4.5/10 (45.0%); since 2025 score 67.5/109 (61.9%). The table below separates current move orders from older historical preferences.

Date	Side	Opponent	Result	Setup
2026.05.04	Black	Rughani, Mahin	0-1	KID / ...d6 fianchetto: 1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. g3 c5 4. d5 exd5
2026.04.06	White	Cont, Arya	0-1	Bird Opening: 1. f4 Nf6 2. Nf3 d5 3. g3 e6 4. Bg2 c5
2026.04.06	White	Sharma, Devesh	1-0	Aggressive queen-pawn flank-pawn setup: 1. d4 f5 2. g4 fxg4 3. h3 g3 4. fxg3 d5
2026.04.06	White	Cont, Arya	0-1	Bird Opening: 1. f4 Nf6 2. Nf3 d5 3. g3 e6 4. Bg2 c5
2026.04.06	White	Sharma, Devesh	1-0	Aggressive queen-pawn flank-pawn setup: 1. d4 f5 2. g4 fxg4 3. h3 g3 4. fxg3 d5
2026.04.05	Black	Kudaibergen, Nurlykhan	1-0	Alekhine Defence: 1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. Bc4 Nb6
2026.04.05	Black	Kudaibergen, Nurlykhan	1-0	Alekhine Defence: 1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. Bc4 Nb6
2026.04.05	White	Baer, Bruce L	1/2-1/2	Pirc/Modern as White: 1. e4 g6 2. d4 Bg7 3. Nc3 a6 4. a4 d6

5. Game Plan For Lachlan

If You Are Black

Against 1.e4, choose your most familiar defence over novelty-hunting. He has enough open-game/Sicilian experience that a half-known sharp line is the real danger.

If You Are White

Against ...Nf6/...g6/...Bg7, stay in Catalan/Reti mode: c4, g3, Bg2, d4, keep central tension, and decide early whether dxe5/dxc5 clarifies in your favour.

Practical Match Plan

Do not chase tactics unless the forcing line is fully calculated; make compensation prove itself.

Trade into better structure when he accepts isolated pawns, backward pawns, or a weak colour complex.

Prepare one forcing branch against the top repeated setup, then spend the rest of prep on plans and pawn breaks rather than memorising sidelines.

6. Before-The-Round Checklist

Review White rep / Reti and Catalan files against ...Nf6/...g6/...Bg7; decide dxc5/dxe5 trigger points.

Bring one practical target to the board: a pawn break, a trade into better structure, or a line that removes his favourite attacking plan.

7. Appendix: Representative Setups

Side	Setup family	Representative line	Read over the board
His White	Open/anti Sicilian with 1.e4	1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 d6 3. g3 Nc6 4. Bg2 g6 5. d3 Bg7 6. f4 Nf6	Use a familiar defence; he is comfortable in open/semi-open play.
His White	French as White	1. e4 e6 2. Qe2 Be7 3. Nf3 d5 4. d3 Nf6 5. g3 dxe4 6. dxe4 Nc6	Prepare the pawn break and piece placement, not just the first two moves.
His White	Caro-Kann as White	1. e4 c6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 g6 4. g3 Bg7 5. Bg2 e5 6. Ngf3 Ne7	Prepare the pawn break and piece placement, not just the first two moves.
His White	Scotch/Open Game central d4	1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 exd4 4. Bc4 Nf6 5. e5 d5 6. Bb5 Ne4	Prepare the pawn break and piece placement, not just the first two moves.
His White	Grand Prix / Closed Sicilian	1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. g3 g6 4. Bg2 Bg7 5. f4 e6 6. e5 d6	Use a familiar defence; he is comfortable in open/semi-open play.
His Black	Alekhine Defence	1. e4 Nf6 2. Nc3 d5 3. exd5 Nxd5 4. Nxd5 Qxd5 5. Nf3 Bg4 6. Be2 Nc6	Choose a stable structure and make his repeated setup prove itself.
His Black	Dutch Defence	1. d4 f5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. O-O O-O 6. c4 d6	Choose a stable structure and make his repeated setup prove itself.
His Black	KID / ...d6 fianchetto	1. d4 Nf6 2. Nf3 g6 3. Bf4 Bg7 4. e3 d6 5. h3 O-O 6. Be2 Nc6	Catalan/Reti pressure; keep central tension and watch ...c5/...e5 timing.
His Black	KID/fianchetto vs flank	1. c4 f5 2. Nc3 Nf6 3. d4 g6 4. g3 Bg7 5. Bg2 O-O 6. Nf3 d6	Catalan/Reti pressure; keep central tension and watch ...c5/...e5 timing.
His Black	...Nf6/...g6 fianchetto vs flank	1. Nf3 g6 2. g3 Bg7 3. d4 f5 4. b3 c5 5. Bb2 cxd4 6. Bxd4 Nf6	Catalan/Reti pressure; keep central tension and watch ...c5/...e5 timing.

8. Sources And Limits

Local En Croissant prep folder PGNs, with one-game files and .info sidecars from local Mega, Chess-Results and Lichess broadcasts where available.

Raw source files: 315; deduped games used in this report: 274.

No fresh engine pass was run. Tactical, positional, strength and weakness conclusions are scouting inferences from openings, results, structures and representative games.